

Master of the Seven Seas — Art Direction Guide v2.2

CORRECTED MASTER GUIDE — OLD SIGILS SUPERSEDED

The newly supplied faction sigils below are the current authoritative visual canon. Earlier faction-sigil artwork in previous art-direction boards is superseded.



CURRENT OFFICIAL SIGILS — supplied September 15, 2026

1. Visual North Star

Stylized cinematic pirate-adventure illustration: painterly, richly detailed, historically grounded Age-of-Sail construction, colorful and readable at game scale. Adventure first, charm second, darkness selectively.

2. Visual Laws

- Historical maritime construction is the foundation.
- Fantasy enhances the maritime world; it does not replace it.
- Every major object needs a strong, readable silhouette.
- Faction identity comes from construction philosophy, not merely color.
- Crown designs are ordered, refined and standardized.
- Confederate designs are individualistic, improvised and culturally varied.
- Supernatural elements use a distinct nautical visual language.
- Detail must survive reduction to game-display size.
- Reference-card presentation is not a template for standalone production art.
- Physical geometry always takes priority over dramatic perspective.

3. Faction Identity

Crown Imperium

Deep Imperial/botanical green, antique gold/brass, ivory, black iron and refined wood. Clean, symmetrical, maintained, disciplined and formidable. Crown power should look civilized and impressive, never sinister.

Official Crown emblem: the supplied gold crown + anchor + compass/star + laurel + wave heraldic mark.

Crown does not use visible coral as a normal construction or warding material. Crown supernatural defense is expressed through disciplined Tidecraft and engineered warding.

Free Confederacy

Crimson/rust red, black, weathered wood, leather, brass, cream, patched/dyed sails, unusual rigging, whalebone and locally sourced materials. Ships feel individualized, charismatic and improvised rather than standardized.

Official Confederacy emblem: the supplied skull + red headscarf + crossed cutlasses + compass/star maritime mark.

CORAL = CONFEDERACY. Living coral, coral-grown hulls and coral architecture are exclusive visual markers of Confederate/Reef-folk maritime culture. Coral is not mandatory on every Confederate vessel.

4. Sigil Reproduction Standard

- The supplied high-resolution emblems are the master visual references.
- For sails, flags and other flat surfaces, use clean 2D adaptations of these exact marks.
- For monochrome or UI use, simplify texture and secondary ornament without changing the underlying symbol.
- For very small icons, retain the strongest identifying core rather than attempting to preserve every decorative detail.
- Do not invent alternate primary faction sigils.
- Do not substitute a generic crown, anchor, skull-and-crossbones or crossed-swords symbol.

5. Reference vs Production

Art-direction boards may show finished card presentation, frames, faction badges, titles or UI-like elements. Those examples establish visual language only. Standalone production assets must follow their asset-specific specifications and should not automatically include those presentation elements.

6. Game-Scale Readability

- Silhouette test: recognizable without color.
- Faction test: recognizable without emblem or label.
- Thumbnail test: focal subject remains clear when reduced.
- Use one obvious focal subject and controlled background detail.
- Do not allow decorative detail to overwhelm the identifying shape.

7. Naval Continuity

Crown II ships represent deliberate technological evolution of established Crown families. The Confederacy has no standardized II variants; its ships represent alternate solutions, cultures and individual captains. Captured vessels retain their original structural bones while acquiring their new faction's modifications.

8. Supernatural Language

Use spectral teal, sea-green, moonlit cyan, deep violet, strange stars, unnatural fog, bioluminescence, ghost light, ancient stone and oceanic imagery. Supernatural cards may push further stylistically while remaining recognizably part of the same maritime universe.

9. Master Rule

If a visual choice makes an asset less immediately readable as Master of the Seven Seas, less distinct by silhouette, or visually confuses the two factions, simplify or redesign it.